Project Proposals – Elah Center for Coping with Loss

Since the outbreak of the Iron Swords War, the Israeli government has significantly expanded the provision of psychological assistance to direct victims, alongside substantial support from philanthropic organizations. This reflects a growing and encouraging recognition of the profound psychosocial needs created by the war.

Nevertheless, experience from the field indicates that many individuals continue to fall between the cracks—**either because they are not eligible for government funding or because existing frameworks do not adequately address their specific circumstances**. For these individuals, the Elah Center seeks to provide appropriate, tailored therapeutic support, made possible through philanthropic donations.

1. Support Groups for Individuals Coping with Grief or Trauma

Within the population affected by the war, there are individuals with urgent psychosocial needs who do not meet the criteria for government-funded assistance. These include, among others, mothers and partners of combat soldiers, female lone soldiers, bereaved commanders, close friends of fallen soldiers and civilians, second-degree family members of fallen soldiers or civilians (both Jewish and Arab), family members of wounded or traumatized soldiers, and first-line emergency personnel. Requests for support groups for these populations are received regularly by the Elah Center.

Given the emotional intensity and complexity of the issues addressed, each group is facilitated by two qualified therapists. Groups meet for a minimum of 12 sessions, with the option to extend to 30 or even 40 sessions, depending on participants' needs and the availability of funding.

The cost of a single group session with two therapists is NIS 3,000, resulting in a total cost of NIS 36,000 for a basic 12-session group.

2. Individual Therapy for People Coping with Grief or Trauma

Many individuals affected by the war do not meet the criteria for government-funded psychological care and require individualized support that cannot be provided in group settings. These individuals turn to the Elah Center seeking subsidized, professional therapy.

Philanthropic support enables timely intervention for people experiencing significant grief or trauma, preventing further deterioration and long-term harm.

The cost of a one-hour individual therapy session, provided in our clinics or online, is NIS 345. A basic therapeutic package of 20 sessions—considered the minimum for meaningful intervention—totals NIS 6,900.

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3. Social-Therapeutic Support Groups for the Elderly

Older adults in Israel are among the populations most deeply affected by the prolonged state of war. Advanced age, declining health, and increasing social isolation already place many elderly individuals at heightened risk for anxiety, depression, and loneliness; the ongoing security situation has significantly intensified these vulnerabilities.

Demand for the Elah Center's social-therapeutic groups for the elderly continues to grow. Drawing on 45 years of experience, Elah has developed therapeutic methods specifically adapted to the needs of this population. Facilitated by professional therapists, the groups employ a wide range of tools—including music, photographs, games, art, movement, animals, and gardening—to foster meaningful social connections, strengthen cognitive and social skills, and reduce war-related stress, anxiety, and isolation.

For participants experiencing cognitive decline, tailored interventions such as art, music, movement, animal-assisted, and gardening therapy support communication, emotional regulation, and a sense of calm.

Each group includes an average of 12 participants and meets once a week for 90-minute sessions. The cost per session is NIS 1,500, bringing the total cost of a 20-session group to NIS 30,000.

4. Individual Therapy for Homebound Elderly

Older adults in Israel are among the populations most deeply affected by the prolonged state of war. Advanced age, declining health, and increasing isolation place many elderly individuals at heightened risk for anxiety, depression, and loneliness, risks that have been further intensified by the ongoing security situation. Many report a resurgence of traumatic memories, persistent fear, sleep disturbances, and deep concern for children and grandchildren serving in the military. As mobility decreases and social networks shrink, access to appropriate mental health care becomes both more urgent and more difficult. Many elderly individuals, including a significant number of Holocaust survivors, are not eligible for state-funded assistance.

Since its establishment in 1979, the Elah Center has provided specialized, trauma-informed mental health care for elderly individuals and Holocaust survivors, grounded in a strong ethical commitment to dignity, continuity, and individualized treatment. As clients age, the need for flexible, relationship-based care delivered in the home has become increasingly critical.

The cost of a one-hour in-home therapy session is NIS 400. A basic treatment package of 20 sessions totals NIS 8,000.

5. Group and Individual Therapy for the Arab Community in Israel

The Arab community in Israel faces a unique and often overlooked mental-health burden shaped by prolonged exposure to social stressors, violence, discrimination, and poverty. The recent war has further intensified this reality, bringing additional loss, trauma, and insecurity to the community. Despite these

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challenges, access to culturally sensitive mental-health services remains limited, and stigma continues to prevent many individuals from seeking help.

Experience gained by the Elah Center for Coping with Loss demonstrates that when professional mental-health care is made accessible and culturally appropriate, individuals and families make meaningful and grateful use of it. Since 2010, the Elah Center has operated a clinic in Kfar Kanna, providing culturally adapted therapeutic services through a professional team of more than 50 Arabic-speaking therapists.

Individual and group therapy are offered in clinics or, when needed, in clients' homes—within trusted and familiar settings—allowing participants to process grief, trauma, and chronic stress in their own language. Group therapy reduces isolation and restores a sense of belonging, while individual therapy enables deeper, personalized support. Investment in these therapeutic frameworks not only alleviates immediate psychological distress but also strengthens family resilience, and much needed community stability and long-term social cohesion.

Each group includes an average of 12 participants and meets weekly for 90-minute sessions. The cost per group session is NIS 1,500, with a total cost of NIS 18,000 for a 12-session group.

The cost of a one-hour individual therapy session, provided in clinics or online, is NIS 345. A basic therapeutic package of 20 sessions totals NIS 6,900.

Objectives

The objective of all programs, in both individual and group settings, is to support the emotional processing of participants' unique experiences while strengthening internal resilience, coping skills, and personal and social identity. Through professionally facilitated interventions that combine psychoeducation with guided sharing, participants are offered a safe, structured environment for mutual support, learning, and connection.

Regular group engagement fosters a sense of belonging, reduces isolation, and helps build supportive peer networks that extend beyond the therapeutic setting. By strengthening both personal and relational resilience, the programs contribute to the prevention of isolation and suicide, enhance emotional recovery, and enable participants to maintain personal and professional functioning—an essential foundation for individual well-being and broader societal stability.

Conclusion

Elah Center possess the professional knowledge, therapists, and infrastructure required to provide this support nationwide. The only missing component is funding. We hope you will be our partner in our effort to raise resources in order to provide this response, as part of an effort to build a more just and resilient society.

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